to hear broken English spoken is a rarity, you find many of the first men in the country who can not speak Persian, others who can not speak Turkish and again some who speak nothing but Koordish. This makes the natives of the country lenient to a foreigner, they try to help him on and sometimes will speak broken Persian and Turkish themselves thinking he will understand them better; and as to writing there are some men of rank who do not write so well as I do; altho education in Persia is very general, particularly in midland Persia, still you find many men of rank who do not read or write at all. I have met learned men, who have been well read in Persian and Arabic literature driving mules or working in melon grounds. I pay one sailcroon (shilling) a month for the schooling of a little boy the son of my servant. This cheapness enables many to learn. But many after thirty years study can not earn so much as they can gardening or mule driving, and they prefer those healthy occupations to living in a small cell in the center of a filthy city.

I think Sir Robt Peel is quite right about Maynooth and can not understand why my fellow country-men should be so illiberal.[92] Your political remarks are very clever and to me most amusing altho I often disagree with you. In reading over the newspapers, I often say to myself I shall be curious to see what my dear Mother will think of this, then in a few days comes your letter. Poor Sir Robert. How you clapper-claw him. But if I recollect right you used to be-maul Lord John Russel[93] and the Whigs just as much. I am also much amused at Catharine Foljambe's admiration of the knights of old. I think there is more real courage and gallantry displayed by a captain of black infantry in the companies service at such a fight as that of Hyderabad[94] than in a whole life of one of those worthies who would ride down and slaughter the foot soldiers, themselves being cased in steel. And as to honour and morality, why there are very few noble families in England some of whose ancestors have not robbed on the high-way. Vide R: Random, Rob Roy etc– Though I confess this same robbing on the high-road is to me amongst the least of their crimes. I have known many a good fellow in Persia who had occasionally been out on that account. In many parts of Koordistan most young men of family do it; if two parties meet, its either we strip you, or you strip us, and the party who are beaten, are stripped. This sort of robbing does no great harm. But the sort of robbing I would hang men for is this; suppose a poor villager has taken a few mule-loads of dried fruits or other merchandize to Baghdad and after having risked his life and what is perhaps worse, his health in the burning and sandy deserts or snowy mountains, and is

[92] Sir Robert Peel was Prime Minister from 1841–1846. The increased endowment to the Irish college of Maynooth aroused considerable local opposition in England.

[93] The Opposition to the Peel government; later his successor as prime minister.

[94] An incident in Lord Ellenborough's successful enterprise to conquer the Gwalior district for the British.

Generated on 2020-09-16 00:17 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112393
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN